

May 19, 2026

Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - MACH Alliance

Invited everett.zufelt@orium.com James Savva gus@div-brands.com
tim.benniks@contentstack.com Holly Hall dwessel@viax.io amartin@viax.io
danny.lake@orium.com Rebecca Veldon george.fitzgibbons@vercel.com
dehillard@mcfadyen.com d.kerpel@labdigital.nl husain.khan@workato.com
joel@agilitycms.com morten.n@bluestonepim.com ryan.lunka@ariessolutions.io
Jasmin Guthmann stroppad@amazon.com deepakj@tblocks.com
mahesh@ingestlabs.com nick.tomasseti@aprimo.com craig.oley@wegmans.com
~~ashwin@mastra.ai~~ ~~philip.lakin@zapier.com~~ ~~yann.boisclair-roy@altitude-sports.com~~
~~sana@conscia.ai~~ ~~Mike Sandoz~~ ~~ameya.deshmukh@everworker.ai~~

Attachments  Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - M...

Summary

Working group aligned on agent definitions and enterprise strategies via repository governance and collaborative content planning.

Repository Governance Established

Participants mandated pull requests for all main branch contributions to ensure quality control. The group also formally aligned on targeting enterprise architects and CTOs as their primary audience.

Defining Agentic Systems

The group decided to create a concise, 2-sentence definition of an agent for

shared vocabulary. They adopted a 5-bucket spectrum model to categorize agent complexity for enterprises.

Content Strategy Planning

Collaborators agreed to build an evolving guide that balances foundational content with advanced architectural insights. They will organize the backlog to address 8 to 10 practical items.

Rate this Summary: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Decisions

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

ALIGNED

- **Repository contribution governance model** The group established a repository governance model requiring all contributions to be submitted via pull requests rather than direct pushes.
- **Five-step agent spectrum definition** The group adopted a five-step spectrum ranging from deterministic flows to cross-domain agent collaboration as the standard shared vocabulary and definition of an agent.
- **Target audience and persona strategy** The group decided to target future content, reference architectures, and guidance primarily towards CTOs and enterprise architects, focusing on systems and strategy.
- **Comprehensive spectrum coverage strategy** The group committed to covering the entire five-step agent spectrum rather than narrowing the scope, adopting a divide-and-conquer approach to produce content across all levels.

- **Documentation formatting standards** The group established a documentation standard to prioritize concise, white-paper style writing over long-form content to optimize for reader engagement and efficient token usage.

Next steps

- ☐ [Rebecca Veldon] Resolve Repo Governance: Evaluate GitHub repository permissions and governance settings to ensure access is appropriately configured. Resolve all access issues before the next meeting.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt] Draft Agent Definition: Draft an article defining agents using the 5 bucket spectrum model. Upload the document to the GitHub deliverables subfolder in markdown format.
- ☐ [The group] Edit Agent Article: Review and edit the agent definition document in the GitHub repository. Provide feedback through pull requests to finalize the content.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt] Post Draft: Upload the revised version of the article to GitHub.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt] Comment Issue: Add remarks to issue 4 on the repository.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt, George Fitzgibbons, Tim Benniks] Define Backlog: Meet for 30 minutes to outline 8 to 10 priority items for the upcoming 3 months.
- ☐ [Devon Hilllard] Increase Activity: Participate consistently in the Slack channel to sustain discussions between meetings.
- ☐ [Rebecca Veldon] Add Members: Manage Slack channel access and invitations for the group.

Details

- **GitHub Repository Access and Governance:** Rebecca Veldon confirmed that the working group's GitHub repository is public, allowing everyone to view the content. Tim Benniks and George Fitzgibbons discussed the necessity of governing the main branch, reaching a consensus that contributions should be managed through pull requests to maintain quality and control, rather than allowing direct pushes. Everett Zufelt suggested limiting direct write access to a

small group of contributors while requiring others to use pull requests, which was supported as a standard practice for this collaborative marketing and documentation effort.

- **Working Group Introductions and Backgrounds:** Tim Benniks and Danny Lake provided introductions regarding their roles and expertise. Tim Benniks described their focus on developer experience and AI tooling at Content Stack, while Danny Lake noted their role as a staff architect at ORM, working on building agents. Both participants acknowledged that they were catching up with the progress of the work group, having missed the previous session.
- **Defining the Scope of the Working Group:** Devon Hilllard initiated a discussion on the scope of the group's work, framing the challenge as distinguishing between deterministic services that leverage large language models and truly agentic systems that work intelligently toward a goal. The group agreed that defining where they provide value on this gradient is critical to setting the direction for their documentation and guidance deliverables.
- **Tangible Agent Use Cases:** To ground the discussion, participants shared examples of agents they have built. Devon Hilllard described building Model Context Protocol servers and deterministic services for customer service optimization, while Daniele Stroppa mentioned working on a marketing agent that generates briefs, copies, and visual assets. Tim Benniks added an example of an agent that monitors competition to propose content creation.
- **The Need for a Clear Definition:** The group reached a consensus that they needed a concise, two-sentence definition of an "agent" to serve as a shared vocabulary for their work, rather than a lengthy or overly technical explanation. Participants felt this was necessary to move the conversation from abstract theory to tangible deliverables that can be understood by non-technical stakeholders.
- **The Agent Spectrum Proposal:** Everett Zufelt proposed a five-bucket model to define agents, ranging from deterministic flows that use language models for content synthesis to long-running, policy-driven agents and multi-agent collaborations. The group discussed this spectrum as a way to provide an "on-ramp" for enterprises to understand and adopt agentic architectures at their own pace, starting from simpler, deterministic implementations.
- **Enterprise Considerations and Risks:** Devon Hilllard and Everett Zufelt emphasized the importance of addressing enterprise-level challenges such as traceability, reproducibility, observability, and risk management. The group noted

that as enterprises move toward more complex agentic systems, these governance concerns become increasingly significant, making it vital for the working group to provide clear, actionable guidance on these topics.

- **Strategic Alignment on Target Audience:** The group aligned on targeting their documentation and reference architectures toward CTOs and enterprise architects who are responsible for systems and strategy. Participants agreed that while they may write for technical leads, their primary objective is to serve the end users who are tasked with implementing these technologies in enterprise environments.
- **Article Collaboration and Content Strategy:** Everett Zufelt committed to drafting an article defining what an agent is, to be hosted on GitHub for collaborative editing by the group. The group agreed to use their own tools to maintain a consistent voice and tone, with George Fitzgibbons offering to help use their internal frameworks to assist in producing the content.
- **Future Work and Backlog Management:** George Fitzgibbons suggested that the group move forward by creating a backlog of items to tackle over the next few months, starting with the agreed-upon five-bucket definition. Everett Zufelt and Tim Benniks agreed to organize a short planning session to outline the next eight to ten backlog items, focusing on providing practical, implementable guidance.
- **Balancing Simplicity and Innovation:** The group discussed the "innovator's dilemma," acknowledging the challenge of balancing simple, foundational content that helps beginners with the need to lead by exploring advanced, complex use cases. Participants concluded that they must "do it all" by covering the entire spectrum, providing both the entry-level on-ramps and the advanced architectural insights that will define the future of the field.
- **Commitment to Continuous Improvement:** Participants agreed that their output should be "dated" and frequently updated to reflect the rapidly evolving nature of AI and agent technology. Tim Benniks and Everett Zufelt emphasized that they are building a guide that will evolve over time, ensuring the material remains useful and relevant for the community.
- **Communication and Closing Steps:** Devon Hillard and other participants committed to being more active in the designated Slack channel to maintain conversation between meetings. Rebecca Veldon confirmed that any remaining access issues would be resolved quickly, and the meeting concluded with agreement on the next steps for documentation and backlog planning.

You should review Gemini's notes to make sure they're accurate. [Get tips and learn how Gemini takes notes](#)

How is the quality of **these specific notes**? [Take a short survey](#) to let us know your feedback, including how helpful the notes were for your needs.